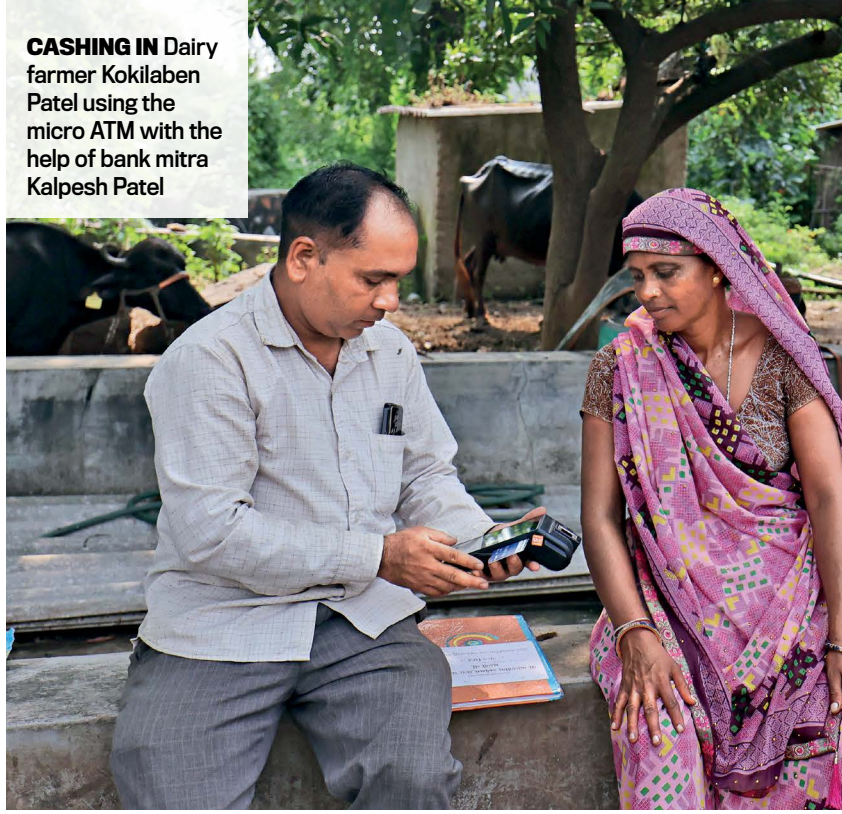
deals and called its protagonists "420" (cheats). "My government's Vision 2047 plan is aimed at developing the state... the '420' will not understand it. After one call, 29,881 farmers had come forward to donate 34,241 acres in this region," claims Naidu. He's talking of the voluntary land pooling system from his earlier government (2014-19) where, in exchange for serviced residential and commercial plots and other safety benefits, farmers had donated land for the capital city.

THE GOAL IS TO GENERATE 2 MILLION JOBS AND 'NOT ONLY ATTRACT BUT ALSO BUILD GLOBAL BRANDS'

The WB and ADB have, in principle, committed to finance the first phase of Amaravati's development to the tune of $1,600 million (Rs 13,600 crore). The Centre will fund the remaining Rs 1,400 crore. Funding for the second phase will depend on how soon the first phase is completed.

Are Amaravati and Andhra Pradesh then on the "rebound", as Naidu's camp will have us believe? Analysts contend that it is a daunting task, adding that it will work only if he can successfully implement the economic and industrial policy, unveiled on October 17, for the next five years. The goal is to generate 2 million jobs and create an ecosystem to 'not only attract but also build global brands'. Jobs and development are poll promises he has articulated in six documents released so far. On paper, the plans seem perfect, but Naidu, once known as the 'CEO of Andhra Pradesh', will need much more than marketing skills to make Amaravati a reality and a showcase for the state in its transformation from an agrarian economy to a 21st century industry powerhouse. ■



CASHING IN Dairy farmer Kokilaben Patel using the micro ATM with the help of bank mitra Kalpesh Patel

GUJARAT COOPERATIVES

THE ATM THAT EMPOWERS

By Jumana Shah

Kokilaben Patel has seen Kalpesh Patel operate the micro ATM many times but she's still fascinated by the steps that leads to him handing her Rs 3,000. A resident of Mahuliya village, Godhra taluka in Panchmahal district in Gujarat, the dairy farmer never went to school, but in the past year has emerged as a family matriarch of sorts after she learnt basic banking through the micro ATM she accesses at home. The 50-year-old manages the household finances now, and her prudence helped in the purchase of the family's tractor.

Kokila is among the thousands of women members of the Multipurpose Primary Agricultural Credit Cooperative Societies (MPACS) at the village level who have been given debit/credit cards to operate micro ATMs of the district cooperative central banks (DCCBs) of the Panchmahal and Banaskantha districts. Micro ATMs are similar to point-of-sale mobile devices that connect to the bank server via a GPRS. They provide basic services like cash deposit, withdrawal, fund transfer and balance inquiry. A local trained 'bank mitra' provides all aid.

This September, Union minister for home and cooperation Amit Shah launched White Revolution 2.0 which aims to transform the dairy cooperative sector and empower women through the ambitious 'Cooperation among Cooperatives' initiative. "In Gujarat, 3.6 million women are involved in the dairy sector and they do business worth Rs 60,000 crore annually. White Revolution 2.0 will em-